The 4th International Conference on Accounting, Economics, Finance and Management (ICAEFM 2026)
November 19th, 2026
Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam

Subjective Norm, Tuition Provider Reputation, and Intention to Pursue the Icaew Qualification at A Tuition Provider: Evidence from Vietnam

Le Bich Tran[1], Pham Ngoc Duong[1], Pham Lam Duy Anh[1]

[1]*University of Finance – Marketing*

Abstract

This paper examines the relationships between subjective norm, tuition provider reputation and learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification in Vietnam, using T.A.D Learning as the empirical context. The analysis uses 268 valid survey responses collected in May 2026 and the original six-factor PLS-SEM model, with all six paths reported. Subjective norm (SN) and tuition provider reputation (REP) recorded the two largest effect sizes among the six explanatory constructs, although the effects were small and not statistically different from those of career opportunity and educational support. Bootstrapping with 5,000 resamples shows positive and statistically significant relationships between SN and intention ($\beta = 0.316$, $p < 0.001$) and between REP and intention ($\beta = 0.321$, $p < 0.001$). Descriptively, perceived employer preference for ICAEW-qualified candidates is the highest-rated SN item (mean = 4.373), while perceived teaching quality and learner support at T.A.D Learning is the highest-rated REP item (mean = 4.019). Documentary analysis of the Next Generation ACA describes 14 examinations, 25 professional skills across five competency areas and specialised learning, with technology, sustainability and ethics integrated across the qualification. The findings highlight the relevance of social influence and tuition provider reputation to learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning within this cross-sectional convenience sample. The focus on SN and REP was chosen after the full model was estimated and is exploratory. The ACA provides documentary context only. Tuition providers may benefit from credible professional referents and visible evidence of teaching quality and learner support.

Keywords: ICAEW, PLS-SEM, professional accounting qualification, subjective norm, tuition provider reputation

JEL codes: I23, M31, M41

1. Introduction

Professional accounting education is being reshaped by changes in the work expected of accountants. Digital technologies, data-intensive decision-making, sustainability reporting, ethical complexity and broader stakeholder expectations increasingly require accountants to combine technical knowledge with analysis, judgement and communication. International professional bodies have consequently expanded the competency expectations associated with qualification and professional development. The ICAEW Next Generation ACA provides a particularly clear example of this development. The current ACA comprises 14 business, finance and accountancy examinations across Certificate, Professional and Advanced Levels, with

sustainability, ethics and technology embedded across the examination structure (Institute of Chartered Accountants in England and Wales [ICAEW], 2025, 2026b).

The qualification has also introduced a new professional-skills architecture. ICAEW specifies 25 professional skills across five key competency areas: communication, critical thinking, emotional intelligence, leadership and professionalism, supported by a three-stage proficiency model. Professional skills complement technical learning and are developed through the training agreement, while Specialised Learning provides tailored opportunities across technical and non-technical areas (ICAEW, 2026a, 2026c). These developments provide the professional context for examining learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning.

At the same time, learners' intention to pursue professional qualifications is shaped by social, educational and employment environments. Previous research has identified career opportunity, capability, social influence, attitude and qualification-related conditions as determinants of professional qualification intention, but the importance of individual factors varies across countries and qualification contexts (Artati et al., 2021; Chi et al., 2022; Hashim & Ghani, 2020; Meliana et al., 2022; Owusu et al., 2018). Vietnamese studies have similarly reported variation while increasingly examining international qualifications such as ACCA and other professional accounting certifications (Ho et al., 2025; Nguyen et al., 2020; Phan et al., 2025; Tran et al., 2023; Tran & Tran, 2024).

A less developed dimension concerns the organisation that supports preparation for the qualification. Tuition providers do not award the professional qualification itself, but they support learners through teaching, learning materials, examination preparation and learner support. Research in higher education has established the relevance of institutional reputation to educational choice and behavioural intention, including in Vietnam (Amoozegar et al., 2025; Bui, 2021; Bui & Esangbedo, 2019; Miotto et al., 2020). However, tuition providers have received limited research attention in the context of professional accounting education. This gap warrants examining the role of tuition providers in learners' intention to study professional accounting qualifications, with particular attention to subjective norm and tuition provider reputation. In this paper, the tuition provider examined is T.A.D Learning, a Vietnamese tuition provider and ICAEW Partner in Learning.

This paper examines two predictors of learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning: subjective norm (SN) and tuition provider reputation (REP). They are taken from a six-construct model that also includes attitude, self-competence, career opportunity and educational support. The literature review was completed and the six hypotheses were set out in the research model before the survey data were collected. SN and REP are reported here because SN is the social-influence construct whose evidence is inconsistent across settings, and REP is a construct at the tuition-provider level that has received little attention in professional accounting education. This selection was made after the full model had been estimated and was informed by the estimated effects as well as by theoretical interest. The emphasis on these two constructs is therefore exploratory. To limit selective reporting, the measurement and structural results for all six constructs are presented. The study addresses two questions: (RQ1) Is SN positively associated with intention to pursue ICAEW at T.A.D Learning? (RQ2) Is REP positively associated with that intention? The Next Generation ACA is reviewed from official ICAEW documents to describe the qualification context. Its competencies were not measured and are not treated as determinants of intention.

2. Literature Review and Hypothesis Development

2.1. Professional accounting qualification intention

Intention is a central construct in the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB). Intention is conceptualised as the immediate antecedent of behaviour, shaped by attitude, subjective norm and perceived behavioural control (Ajzen, 1991). In professional accounting education, researchers have extended behavioural models to incorporate capability, career opportunity, social beliefs and qualification-related constraints because pursuing a professional qualification involves sustained investment in time, effort and financial resources.

An early stream of research applied the Belief, Preference and Constraint (BPC) model. A study of 641 business students in Ghana found that capability, career opportunity and socio-cultural factors were positively associated with intention to pursue a certified professional accountancy qualification, whereas constraints were not statistically significant (Owusu et al., 2018). Research involving 245 Malaysian accounting students similarly found significant relationships involving preference for professional membership, job-prospect beliefs, social beliefs and capability beliefs, while constraints were not statistically significant (Hashim & Ghani, 2020).

Research using TPB has produced less consistent evidence. A study of accountants in Central Java found that perceived behavioural control was significant for interest in obtaining the Chartered Accountant title, while attitude and subjective norm were not significant (Artati et al., 2021). Research involving 339 Malaysian accounting students reported capability as the strongest determinant, followed by perceived behavioural control and career opportunity, while attitude and subjective norm were not significant (Chi et al., 2022). Similarly, a study of 155 Indonesian accounting students found positive relationships for capability, perceived behavioural control and career opportunity, while attitude, subjective norm and constraints were not significant (Meliana et al., 2022). These studies indicate that the determinants of professional qualification intention are context-dependent and are not uniformly predicted by the three original TPB components.

Evidence from Vietnam provides a different pattern. Research involving 227 Vietnamese accounting and auditing students found that attitude, subjective norm and perceived behavioural control significantly influenced intention to study professional accounting programmes (Nguyen et al., 2020). A study in Can Tho found that examination regulations, career perspectives and expectations influenced attitude, while attitude and university support affected intention to sit the Vietnamese CPA examination (Nguyen et al., 2022). Research on international accounting certifications in Ho Chi Minh City reported positive effects of attitude, perceived behavioural control and risk acceptance on intention, while reference-group opinion showed a negative relationship (Tran et al., 2023). Research examining 213 Vietnamese accounting and auditing students and practitioners found positive relationships for career opportunity, self-competence, educational support, attitude, subjective norm, and examination regulations and costs (Tran & Tran, 2024). More recent Vietnamese studies broaden the evidence base. Research involving 126 accountants and auditors identified economic motivation, career motivation, qualification motivation, attitude and knowledge of professional qualifications as significant positive factors associated with intention to pursue international professional accounting certifications (Phan et al., 2025). Further studies have examined Vietnamese accounting students' intentions to pursue professional accounting qualifications (Ho et al., 2025), learning environment and student attitude in accounting career intention (Le et al., 2025), and intention to obtain international financial reporting certification (Do, 2025).

Building on this literature, the original research model (Figure 1) includes six constructs, which are attitude (ATT), subjective norm (SN), self-competence (SC), career opportunity (CO), educational support (ES) and tuition provider reputation (REP). This paper focuses on SN and REP, labelled H2 and H6 as in Figure 1.

The other four independent variables (ATT, SC, CO and ES; H1, H3, H4 and H5) remain in the model, and their results are reported in Table 2 without separate discussion.

2.2. Subjective norm and intention

Subjective norm refers to perceived social pressure concerning whether an individual should perform a behaviour (Ajzen, 1991). In professional accounting education, relevant referents can include family members, friends, classmates, lecturers, employers and professional contacts. Social influence can therefore operate through both immediate social relationships and expectations associated with the employment environment.

Empirical findings are mixed. Socio-cultural factors have been identified as relevant to professional qualification intention (Owusu et al., 2018), while studies in Indonesia and Malaysia found subjective norm to be statistically insignificant (Artati et al., 2021; Chi et al., 2022; Meliana et al., 2022). In Vietnam, subjective norm was reported as significant in one study (Nguyen et al., 2020), whereas reference-group opinion showed a negative relationship in another (Tran et al., 2023). Subsequent research reported a positive relationship between subjective norm and intention to pursue ACCA (Tran & Tran, 2024). The variation across these studies provides a basis for examining subjective norm specifically in the ICAEW context.

The present study therefore examines whether subjective norm is positively associated with learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning.

H2: Subjective norm is positively associated with learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning.

2.3. Tuition provider reputation and intention

Tuition provider reputation is conceptually distinct from the reputation of the professional body or the qualification itself. It reflects perceptions of the credibility, standing and quality of the organisation that supports preparation for the qualification. In higher education, reputation has been associated with educational choice and behavioural intention. Studies have examined university reputation in relation to university choice and behavioural intention in Vietnam (Bui, 2021; Bui & Esangbedo, 2019). Miotto et al. (2020) likewise highlighted the relationship between reputation and credibility in higher education institutions. More recently, Amoozegar et al. (2025) found that university reputation and academic quality significantly influenced university selection among Vietnamese postgraduate students.

The professional accounting context differs from conventional university choice because the tuition provider does not award the qualification. Its role is to facilitate preparation, progression and examination readiness. Reputation may therefore act as an external signal of expected educational service quality, particularly where prospective learners face uncertainty about teaching quality, learner support and examination preparation.

Existing research on professional accounting qualification intention has concentrated more heavily on career opportunity, capability, attitude, social influence and qualification-related conditions than on the reputation of the organisation delivering preparation. This provides a basis for examining tuition provider reputation in the present context. Accordingly, the present study examines tuition provider reputation as a distinct construct within the original six-factor model, and not as equivalent to the reputation of ICAEW or of the qualification itself.

H6: Tuition provider reputation is positively associated with learners' intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning.

2.4. Documentary context: Next Generation ACA

This subsection is contextual. According to ICAEW documents, the Next Generation ACA comprises 14 examinations across the Certificate, Professional and Advanced Levels, 25 professional skills in five competency areas (communication, critical thinking, emotional intelligence, leadership and professionalism), and Specialised Learning, with technology, sustainability and ethics integrated across the qualification (ICAEW, 2025, 2026a, 2026b, 2026c). These features describe the qualification that learners are considering. Because the survey did not measure perceptions of these competencies, no hypothesis is derived from them and they are not treated as determinants of intention.

2.5. Synthesis and research gap

The main gap concerns the organisation supporting qualification preparation. Higher education research provides evidence that institutional reputation matters for educational choice, including in Vietnam, but professional accounting qualification research has given less attention to tuition provider reputation as a distinct construct. The present study addresses this gap by examining tuition provider reputation alongside subjective norm in the context of ICAEW qualification intention. The Next Generation ACA is used only as documentary context and is not part of the empirical framework.

3. Methodology

3.1. Research design and data

The study draws on quantitative survey data collected online (Google Forms) in May 2026 from individuals with an interest in professional accounting qualifications. The link was distributed through current T.A.D Learning learner groups, in-person visits to T.A.D Learning classes, ICAEW events and seminars, and lecturers at several universities. A screening question identified respondents who did not know the ICAEW qualification. Of the 317 responses received, 49 from such respondents were excluded, leaving 268 valid observations for analysis. The sample included students in accounting, auditing, finance and related fields from 11 universities (85.8%) and working professionals (14.2%). Of the 268 respondents, 205 (76.5%) had not studied at T.A.D Learning and 63 (23.5%) were current or former learners. All respondents evaluated one tuition provider, T.A.D Learning, which is named in all REP and intention items. The survey used convenience sampling. The findings should therefore be interpreted as evidence from the study population and not as a statistically representative estimate for all prospective ICAEW learners in Vietnam.

3.2. Measures, empirical model and analysis

The dependent construct was intention (INT). All constructs were measured with multi-item five-point Likert scales (1 = strongly disagree, 5 = strongly agree). SN, REP and INT each used five items (Tables 3 and 4 and Appendix A), and ATT, SC, CO and ES used 5, 4, 6 and 5 items. Items were developed from the literature and refined through semi-structured interviews with academics and professionals, company staff and learners. The questionnaire was administered in Vietnamese, and English wording is the authors' translation. REP and INT items refer explicitly to T.A.D Learning, whereas ES items refer to tuition providers in general. The present paper concentrates on SN and REP, and the other four constructs are reported for completeness.

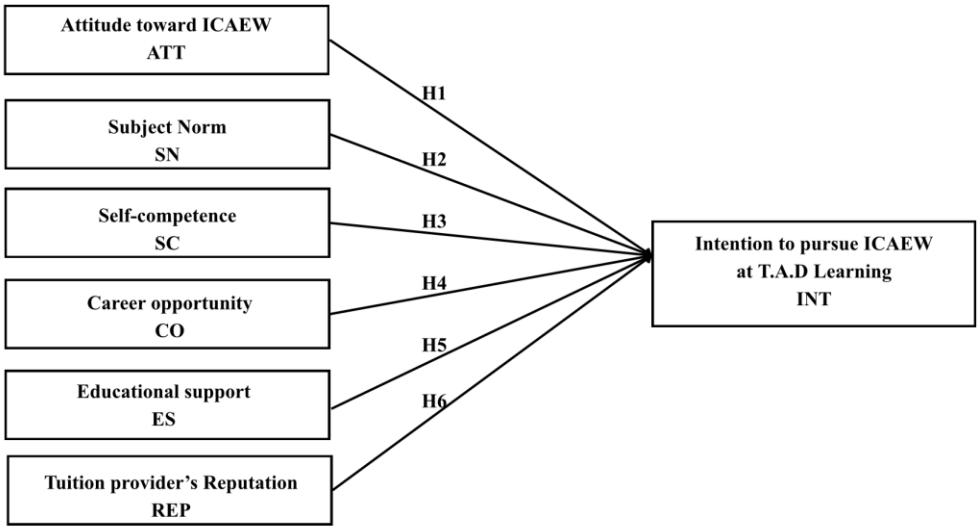


Fig. 1. Original six-factor research model

Source: Authors' proposed research model

PLS-SEM was conducted in SmartPLS 3 (Ringle et al., 2015) using the path weighting scheme. The measurement model was assessed through indicator loadings (0.70 or above preferred, lower values retained when composite reliability and AVE were adequate), Cronbach's alpha, composite reliability, AVE (0.50 or above) and discriminant validity by HTMT (below 0.85) and the Fornell-Larcker criterion (Hair et al., 2019). The structural model was assessed through inner VIF (below 5), path coefficients with 95% bias-corrected and accelerated (BCa) bootstrap confidence intervals (5,000 resamples), R^2, f^2, Q^2 (blindfolding) and SRMR. Differences between path coefficients were examined with percentile confidence intervals computed from the same 5,000 bootstrap samples.

3.3. Documentary analysis

The documentary component draws on four ICAEW publications and web pages on the Next Generation ACA (ICAEW, 2025, 2026a, 2026b, 2026c), accessed in September 2026. Sources were selected because they are ICAEW's official descriptions of the qualification structure, professional skills framework and Specialised Learning requirements. No third-party sources were used. The authors read the documents and recorded the qualification structure, the five competency areas and 25 professional skills, and the themes embedded in examination content (technology, sustainability, ethics), using descriptive content analysis. The material is descriptive context only and was not coded as variables in the survey model.

4. Results and Discussion

4.1. Measurement model

All 35 indicators loaded between 0.634 and 0.898. Five loadings were below 0.70 (CO1 = 0.634, SN5 = 0.649, ATT1 = 0.662, ES5 = 0.680, SN4 = 0.693). These indicators were retained because composite reliability (0.862 - 0.919) and AVE (0.558 - 0.695) met the thresholds for every construct (Table 1). Cronbach's alpha ranged from 0.800 to 0.891. All HTMT values were below 0.85 (maximum 0.830, between ATT and ES; Appendix B), and the square root of each construct's AVE exceeded its correlations with other constructs. Inner VIF values ranged from 1.593 to 3.381 (highest for ES), below 5.

Table 1. Measurement model: reliability and convergent validity

Construct	Items	Loading range	Cronbach's α	CR	AVE
ATT	5	0.662–0.852	0.841	0.882	0.601
SN	5	0.649–0.821	0.800	0.862	0.558
SC	4	0.790–0.858	0.852	0.899	0.690
CO	6	0.634–0.827	0.854	0.891	0.578
ES	5	0.680–0.840	0.842	0.888	0.615
REP	5	0.718–0.895	0.891	0.919	0.695
INT	5	0.759–0.898	0.886	0.917	0.689

Source: Authors' data analysis

4.2. Structural model

Table 2. Structural model results (all six paths)

Path	Role	β	t	p	95% CI	f^2	VIF
SN → INT (H2)	Focal	0.316	4.637	<0.001	[0.18, 0.45]	0.109	2.232
REP → INT (H6)	Focal	0.321	4.289	<0.001	[0.19, 0.49]	0.120	2.083
ATT → INT (H1)	Other	-0.225	2.751	0.006	[-0.40, -0.08]	0.041	3.001
SC → INT (H3)	Other	0.138	2.624	0.009	[0.04, 0.24]	0.029	1.593
CO → INT (H4)	Other	0.216	3.092	0.002	[0.09, 0.36]	0.044	2.545
ES → INT (H5)	Other	0.164	1.604	0.109	[-0.03, 0.37]	0.019	3.381

Note. CI = bias-corrected and accelerated (BCa) 95% confidence interval, 5,000 resamples.

Source: Authors' data analysis

Table 2 reports all six structural paths. SN (β = 0.316) and REP (β = 0.321) were positively associated with intention, supporting H2 and H6. Career opportunity and self-competence were also positive and significant, educational support was not significant (β = 0.164), and attitude was negative (β = -0.225). The negative attitude path contrasts with the positive zero-order correlation between attitude and intention (r = 0.50). Because attitude is highly correlated with REP (0.70), ES (0.71) and CO (0.68), this sign reversal is consistent with collinearity among predictors and is not interpreted substantively. The model explained 58.7% of the variance in intention (adjusted $R^2 = 0.578$) and showed predictive relevance ($Q^2 = 0.390$). SRMR was 0.077.

Relative importance. SN and REP had the largest paths and f^2 values (0.109 and 0.120), although all f^2 values were below 0.15. The two paths did not differ from each other (difference = -0.004, 95% CI [-0.22, 0.22]), and the 95% CIs of their differences from CO and ES all included zero. They differed significantly only from SC (difference = 0.18 for both, 95% CI [0.01, 0.36] and [0.02, 0.36]). We therefore do not claim that SN and REP are more important than career opportunity or educational support.

4.3. Descriptive evidence for subjective norm

Table 3. Descriptive statistics of subjective norm items

Subjective norm item	Mean	SD	Loading
People around me are studying ICAEW	3.410	1.213	0.821
People I trust or value are studying ICAEW	3.675	1.252	0.799
I feel pressure if I do not study ICAEW like my friends/colleagues	3.485	1.235	0.758
Influential people recommend studying ICAEW	3.914	0.958	0.693
Employers I target prefer candidates with ICAEW	4.373	0.776	0.649

Source: Authors' data analysis

Item means and standard deviations are descriptive only. They show where respondents agreed most, but they cannot identify separate effects of individual items on intention. The highest SN mean (perceived employer preference, SN5 = 4.373) belongs to the item with the lowest loading on SN (0.649), so it should not be read as the main component of social influence.

4.4. Descriptive evidence for tuition provider reputation

Table 4. Descriptive statistics of tuition provider reputation items

Tuition provider reputation item	Mean	SD	Loading
T.A.D Learning has a good reputation in the international accounting and auditing qualification community	3.690	1.268	0.718
T.A.D Learning is a reputable provider trusted by many learners	3.925	1.172	0.867
T.A.D Learning's reputation increases confidence in course outcomes	3.877	1.096	0.895
T.A.D Learning has notable examination results and pass-rate performance	3.940	1.140	0.867
T.A.D Learning maintains high standards of teaching and learner support	4.019	1.079	0.810

Source: Authors' data analysis

The highest REP mean is for teaching quality and learner support (REP5 = 4.019), followed by examination performance (REP4 = 3.940). Broader reputation within the international accounting and auditing qualification community (REP1) has the lowest mean (3.690) and the lowest loading (0.718). These item means do not establish distinct effects of any single aspect of reputation on intention.

4.5. Subjective norm and qualification intention

The positive relationship between subjective norm and intention supports H2 and is consistent with Vietnamese evidence reported in previous studies (Nguyen et al., 2020; Tran & Tran, 2024). At the same time, the result differs from studies in Malaysia and Indonesia in which subjective norm was not statistically significant (Artati et al., 2021; Chi et al., 2022; Meliana et al., 2022). The result therefore reinforces the context-dependent nature of social influence in professional accounting education. Because SN is measured with items spanning peers, trusted others, influential referents and employers, the results do not show which referent group drives the association. Its path did not differ significantly from those of career opportunity and educational support (Section 4.2).

4.6. Tuition provider reputation and qualification intention

The positive relationship between tuition provider reputation and intention supports H6. This extends the literature on educational reputation by shifting attention from the reputation of a university toward the organisation that supports preparation for a professional qualification. The result is consistent with evidence that educational reputation is relevant to choice and behavioural intention, including in Vietnam (Amoozegar et al., 2025; Bui & Esangbedo, 2019; Miotto et al., 2020). Tuition providers occupy an intermediate position between the learner and the professional body. They do not confer the qualification, but they influence the learning experience through teaching, support, examination preparation and progression guidance. Because 23.5% of respondents were current or former T.A.D Learning learners, and REP and intention items refer to the same tuition provider, this association may partly reflect respondents' prior experience (Section 5.4).

4.7. Contextual note on the Next Generation ACA

The Next Generation ACA is described in Section 2.4 as the qualification context. The survey did not measure learners' perceptions of its competencies, so the results cannot show that changes in ACA competency expectations explain intention. Future work could measure these perceptions directly.

5. Conclusions and Implications

5.1. Conclusions

This paper examined subjective norm and tuition provider reputation in relation to intention to pursue the ICAEW qualification at T.A.D Learning, with the Next Generation ACA described as documentary context. Using 268 valid survey responses from a cross-sectional convenience sample and PLS-SEM, both subjective norm and tuition provider reputation were positively and statistically significantly associated with intention, with $\beta = 0.316$ and $\beta = 0.321$, respectively. They also recorded the two largest individual effect sizes in the structural model, although their paths did not differ significantly from those of career opportunity or educational support.

The descriptive results provide further insight. Perceived employer preference for ICAEW-qualified candidates was the highest-rated subjective-norm item, while teaching quality and learner support was the highest-rated reputation item. These patterns are consistent with a link between qualification intention and both the professional environment surrounding the learner and the organisation supporting the qualification journey. The Next Generation ACA adds documentary context. Its 14-examination structure, 25

professional skills across five competency areas and Specialised Learning reflect an expansion of professional competence beyond technical knowledge, with technology, sustainability and ethics integrated across the qualification (ICAEW, 2025, 2026a, 2026b, 2026c).

5.2. Implications for tuition providers

First, communication strategies should reflect the professional environment surrounding the qualification. Within this sample, the positive association between subjective norm and intention suggests that prospective learners may respond to credible information about professional expectations, career pathways and the relevance of the qualification to contemporary accounting work. Professional practitioners, alumni, lecturers and employer representatives can provide credible reference points, provided that communication remains evidence-based. Second, reputation should be built through demonstrable educational performance. The highest REP ratings concern teaching quality, learner support and examination performance. Although these ratings are descriptive and do not establish separate effects on intention, tuition providers may strengthen reputation by making these dimensions visible through transparent information on teaching approach, learner support processes, progression and examination outcomes.

Third, the documentary analysis indicates that the changing ACA competency architecture provides a basis for communicating educational value beyond examination preparation, for example by showing how classroom activities connect to the competencies expected in the qualification. Finally, tuition providers should distinguish clearly between the qualification awarded by ICAEW and the educational service provided by the tuition provider. This distinction is particularly important for reputation because learners may evaluate both the professional qualification and the credibility of the organisation supporting their preparation.

5.3. Implications for professional accounting education

For professional bodies and educators, the documentary analysis suggests that qualification value may be increasingly communicated through a combination of credential value and competency value. The Next Generation ACA illustrates this development through the integration of professional skills, specialised learning, technology, sustainability and ethics with technical accounting examinations (ICAEW, 2025, 2026a, 2026b, 2026c). Communication about professional qualifications may therefore place greater emphasis on the capabilities developed through the pathway and the professional situations in which those capabilities are applied.

5.4. Limitations and future research

The empirical evidence is based on 268 valid observations from a convenience sample concentrated largely among students in accounting, auditing and related fields, with working professionals representing a smaller proportion of the sample. All respondents evaluated one tuition provider, T.A.D Learning, and were already familiar with ICAEW. The findings should therefore be interpreted within the study population and not generalised to all prospective professional accounting learners in Vietnam. The cross-sectional design also captures intention but not subsequent enrolment, progression or completion behaviour.

A further limitation concerns the documentary competency analysis. The study uses the Next Generation ACA as contextual evidence of changing professional competence, but the survey did not directly measure learners' perceptions of the 25 professional skills or the digital and sustainability competencies embedded in the qualification. Future research could therefore measure perceived competency value directly and examine its relationship with qualification intention, tuition provider choice and subsequent enrolment. Comparative research across international professional accounting qualifications would also help distinguish qualification-specific effects from broader patterns in professional accounting education.

Longitudinal designs that follow learners from intention to enrolment across several tuition providers would further extend this work.

Declaration of interest: The corresponding author is affiliated with T.A.D Learning, the tuition provider examined in this study. The other authors declare no conflict of interest.

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Appendix A. Intention (INT) items

Item	Wording	Mean	SD	Loading
INT1	I intend to study ICAEW at T.A.D Learning	3.896	0.958	0.834
INT2	I prefer T.A.D Learning when deciding to study ICAEW	4.246	0.811	0.856
INT3	I am willing to enrol in ICAEW at T.A.D Learning	3.974	0.958	0.898
INT4	I plan to study ICAEW at T.A.D Learning in the near future	3.951	1.003	0.794
INT5	I will recommend T.A.D Learning to others who intend to study ICAEW	4.336	0.852	0.759

Appendix B. HTMT (heterotrait-monotrait ratio)

	ATT	SN	SC	CO	ES	REP
SN	0.736					
SC	0.371	0.498				
CO	0.771	0.787	0.553			
ES	0.830	0.828	0.675	0.816		
REP	0.810	0.616	0.288	0.572	0.700	
INT	0.524	0.767	0.543	0.699	0.742	0.620

Source: Authors' data analysis